

WEITING HONG

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Return Prediction, Asset Pricing, Behavioral Finance

EDUCATION

Yale University, School of Management

New Haven, CT

Ph.D. in Financial Economics

Expected 06/2028

- **Relevant Coursework:** Financial Econometrics and Machine Learning, Behavioral Finance, Financial Economics, Macro Finance, Applied Empirical Methods, Corporate Finance, Macro (I, II, Adv), Micro (I, II), Industrial Organization I
- **Teaching Fellow:** Financial Markets & Macro Policy (MBA Fall 2024), Behavioral Finance (MBA Spring 2025, PhD Spring 2026), Entrepreneurial Finance (MBA Fall 2025)

Columbia University, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences

New York, NY

M.A. in Economics

09/2021–12/2022

- **Cumulative GPA:** 4.14/4.00 | **GRE:** 340/340 | **CFA:** Passed Level I Exam in February 2022 (Top 10%)
- **Relevant Coursework:** Theory of International Trade (doctoral), Financial Economics, International Economics, Macro (I, II), Micro (I, II), Econometrics (I, II), Math Methods for Economists
- **Honors:** Program for Economic Research (PER) Summer Fellow
- **Teaching Fellow:** Navigating China (EMBA Summer 2022, MBA Fall 2022)

New York University, Leonard N. Stern School of Business

New York, NY

B.S. in Business Administration (Finance & Statistics)

09/2018–09/2021

- **Cumulative GPA:** 3.99/4.00 (summa cum laude) | **SAT:** 1590/1600 | **ACT:** 36/36
- **Relevant Coursework:** Real Analysis, Linear Algebra, Stochastic Processes, Corporate Finance, Debt Instruments, Equity Valuation, Quantitative Microeconomics, Theory of Probability, Statistical Inference and Regression, Decision Models, Operations Management
- **Honors:** Dean's List, 2020 Sequoia Investment Pitch Competition 1st Place, 2020 Point72 Case Competition 2nd Place, 2019 Powder Gate Stock Pitch Competition 3rd Place
- **Teaching Fellow:** Operations Management (Undergrad Spring 2021), Intro to Marketing (Undergrad Spring 2021)

Great Neck South High School

Great Neck, NY

High School Diploma

09/2018–09/2021

- **Cumulative GPA:** 98.0/100.0 | **AIME:** 7
- **Relevant Coursework:** Multivariable Calculus, AP Calculus BC, AP Physics C (Mechanics & Electricity and Magnetism)
- **Honors:** Salutatorian, Math Team President, AMC Certificate of Distinction, DECA Business Finance Int'l Medalist, Long Island Science Olympiad Optics 1st Place, ABRSM Diploma in Piano Performance, NYSSMA Piano Level 6

REFEREED PUBLICATION

Hong, Weiting (2022). "Trade momentum for alpha". *Finance Research Letters* 50, p. 103300

Abstract: I provide new evidence on the value-relevance of international trade development, the heterogeneous distribution of foreign economic benefits among market participants, and the value-add of additional geographic information disclosure by designing the Trade Momentum Index with publicly available citation share, export volume, and trade barrier data. Using a sample of 13,016 firm-year combinations of goods-exporting U.S. firms between 2008 and 2020, I find that a Trade Momentum Index-based, equal-weight hedge portfolio generates a statistically significant annualized alpha of 17.42% at a Sharpe ratio of 0.8255. This result exhibits robustness as the abnormal returns persist under different factor models.

WORKING PAPERS

Selective Recall and the Story-Statistics Gap in Stock Market Misreaction

Abstract: I document a strong story-statistics gap in stock market misreaction to corporate news: whereas qualitative announcements exhibit significant overreaction, quantitative announcements generate pronounced underreaction. This pattern cannot be fully explained by signal-strength uncertainty, diagnostic expectation, news sentiment, or investor attention. Motivated by experimental evidence, I apply selective recall to the stock-market setting and propose distinct similarity structures for stories and statistics. I hypothesize that narrative content characterizes story-like news, which leads to intra-category interference; numerical precision defines statistical news, which leads to inter-category interference. I construct embedding-based similarity measures and show that theory-predicted misreactions strongly align with empirically observed misreactions across news categories. I additionally propose a measurement error-free approach to testing the model and find strong support for selective recall in announcement-level data.

Conferences: 2027 American Finance Association (AFA) Annual Meeting, 2026 USC Marshall PhD Conference in Finance, 2026 Johns Hopkins University Annual Carey Finance Conference

Information Leakage Prior to SEC Form Filings: Evidence from *TAQ*

With Steven Wei Ho and Mingrui Zhang

Abstract: Using *TAQ* data around trading-hour SEC filings from 2003 to 2024, we document a pre-announcement drift across EDGAR acceptance timestamps: when firms experience significant cash-flow news, 30-minute pre-acceptance returns positively predict 30-minute post-acceptance returns. Momentum, investor attention, recent firm-specific news, and contemporaneous market-wide movements do not explain the pattern; and this pattern would disappear if genuine filing date-times are replaced by placebo with random date-times. Extreme pre-acceptance returns coincide with elevated abnormal volume, informed-trading risk, and directional order flow, and the drift strengthens with SEC enforcement caseload. Our evidence is consistent with filing information reaching prices before public dissemination.

Conferences: 2020 American Finance Association (AFA) PhD Student Poster Session, 2024 Midwest Finance Association, 2024 INFORMS Annual Meeting

OTHER PROJECTS

Effect of Information Asymmetry on the Performance of Small and Young Firms

The Pricing and Positive Externality of Trade Finance amid Uncertainties in Global Value Chains

Master's Thesis

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Columbia University Program for Economic Research

New York, NY

Research Assistant for Professors Donald R. Davis and Tomasz Michalski

05/2022–09/2022

- Examined the spatial dimension of unemployment dynamics by aggregating individual responses from the Current Population Survey
- Analyzed central vs. outskirts, large vs. small labor market differences at the MSA level after controlling for various demographic features
- Reviewed the empirical methods of existing literature to replicate published results and scrutinize the validity of underlying assumptions

Columbia Business School Economics Department

New York, NY

Research Assistant for Professor Shang-Jin Wei

03/2022–12/2022

- Analyzed the differences in disclosure standards among stock exchanges to assess the impact of regulatory environment on asset pricing
- Compared the return volatility and shock reaction of cross-listed equity shares against those of firms listed only on one stock exchange

The World in 2050

New York, NY

Research Assistant for Professor Jeffrey D. Sachs

09/2021–09/2022

- Developed integrated pathways for achieving SDGs worldwide before 2050 by building a dynamic general equilibrium model in GAMS
- Numerically estimated the impact of higher sovereign debt limits and lower interest rates on the development of low-income countries
- Assessed global progress toward the universal access of affordable and clean energy as well as the state of infrastructure in select nations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Citigroup Global Markets, Inc.

New York, NY

Healthcare Investment Banking Analyst

02/2023–06/2023

- Researched client financing needs over the clinical development process and covered 16 accounts across a variety of healthcare verticals
- Performed detailed due diligence and comprehensive valuation exercises (Comps, DCF, SOTP, LBO) to inform client decision making

Citigroup Global Markets, Inc.

New York, NY

Healthcare Investment Banking Summer Analyst

06/2021–08/2021

- Worked on nine client accounts that range from IPO bake-offs and crossover transactions to industry research and M&A deal pitches
- Managed and attended over 40 investor and client calls and contributed to team decision-making by taking detailed notes on discussions

Madison Avenue Partners, LP

New York, NY

Investment Analyst Intern

07/2019–12/2019

- Conducted equity research on domestic and foreign companies to evaluate various special-situation and value investment opportunities
- Assisted the portfolio manager by building financial models, organizing expert calls, translating documents, and making equity screeners

SKILLS

LLM, R, SAS, Python, Java, Excel, MATLAB, Stata, GAMS, WRDS, Bloomberg, FactSet, English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)